



MARK ABRAMSON FOR THE NEW YORK TIMES

Page Revuelta, 3, with his mother, Marina Revuelta, during a candlelight vigil on Monday outside City Hall in Monterey Park, Calif.

NEWS ANALYSIS

Biden’s Errors
On Files Blur
Trump’s Case

By PETER BAKER

WASHINGTON — F.B.I. agents are rummaging through President Biden’s private home. Republicans are on the attack. Democrats are reluctant to defend him. Lawyers are being hired. Witnesses are being interviewed. The press secretary is being pelted with questions she cannot or will not answer.

But amid the familiar soundtrack of scandal in Washington, the most significant cost to the president may be the opportunity cost: Even if nothing comes of the new special counsel investigation into his team’s mishandling of classified documents, politically it has effectively let former President Donald J. Trump off the hook for hoarding secret papers.

The cases are markedly different in their particulars, as has been noted repeatedly. Mr. Biden has cooperated with the authorities, inviting them to search his home, while Mr. Trump defied efforts to recover documents even after being subpoenaed, prompting a judge to issue a search warrant. But they are similar enough that as a practical matter Democrats can no longer use the issue against Mr. Trump politically, and investigators may have a harder time prosecuting him criminally.

Continued on Page A17

24 Days Into Year, 69 Deaths in Mass Shootings

This article is by J. David Goodman, Amy Harmon and Adeel Hassan.

There was the mass shooting near a youth center in Allentown, Pa., and the one at a Subway restaurant in Durham, N.C. Another took place behind a beer hall in Oklahoma City, and another at a strip club outside Columbus, Ohio. Two mass shootings ended parties in different Florida cities.

And that was just on New Year’s Day.

By the start of the fourth week in January, the tally had grown to include at least 39 separate shootings in which four or more people

‘Tragedy Upon Tragedy’
— Fear That Nation
Is Becoming Numb

were injured or killed, according to the Gun Violence Archive, outlining a striking explosion of violence across a range of sites in nearly every corner of the nation that killed at least 69 people.

The deadliest shooting so far took place over the weekend in Monterey Park, Calif., a city with a thriving Asian American commu-

nity where a gunman killed 11 people and wounded nine others inside a popular ballroom dance hall. The authorities said the gunman, who may have targeted his victims and who later killed himself, was a 72-year-old man.

Then, on Monday, came another deadly mass shooting in California. A gunman, whom the authorities said was a 66-year-old man, killed seven people and seriously wounded at least one other person in Half Moon Bay, south of San Francisco.

“At the hospital meeting with victims of a mass shooting when I

Continued on Page A18



HAIYUN JIANG/THE NEW YORK TIMES

On Hot Seat Over a Hot Ticket

Fresh off the Taylor Swift fiasco, Live Nation Entertainment was excoriated by the Senate. Page B5.

For California,
A Baffling Toll
Rises Yet Again

Strict Gun Laws, but a
Spate of Killings

This article is by Holly Secon, Shawn Hubler, David W. Chen and Soumya Karlamangla.

HALF MOON BAY, Calif. — A barrage of gun violence left California searching for answers on Tuesday after the death toll from a series of mass shootings, spanning the state from a farmworker community near San Francisco to a Los Angeles suburb, rose to at least 19 people in less than three days.

The attacks posed yet another challenge for beleaguered Californians, who have only begun to recover from weeks of ferocious rainstorms that flooded homes and smashed piers and levees. Even in a vast state of nearly 40 million people, most everyone was feeling the anguish, no matter where they live.

“We’re exhausted, we’re frightened, we’re angry,” Dr. Garen J. Wintemute, an emergency room doctor who directs the Violence Prevention Research Program at the University of California, Davis, Medical Center, said.

In Northern California, a 66-year-old man was in custody after seven people were shot dead on Monday near Half Moon Bay, a coastal community known for its small, fog-draped farms and an annual pumpkin festival. Officials at the San Mateo County Sheriff’s Office said the suspect, Zhao Chunli, had been employed at one of the farms he attacked and was likely driven by workplace grievances.

In Southern California, investigators continued searching for a motive in the massacre on Saturday night at a ballroom dance hall in Monterey Park, an Asian American enclave where 11 people were killed and nine were wounded. The suspect — Huu Can Tran, 72, a former volunteer dance instructor who the authorities said may have been driven by personal animosities — killed himself on Sunday as the police approached his white van.

Those tragedies, however, were only two in a series of mass shootings this month in a state that, overall, has some of the nation’s lowest mortality rates from gun violence, as well as some of its toughest gun laws. Last week, in an attack that the authorities compared to a drug cartel-style execution, six people were shot dead in rural Tulare County in California’s Central Valley, including a 16-year-old girl and her 10-month-old baby. On Monday night, one person was killed and seven people were wounded in a gun battle in Oakland.

On Tuesday, Gavin Newsom, the California governor, visited Half Moon Bay about 24 hours after trying to console injured victims in Monterey Park. Governor Newsom had been at a hospital when he learned of the Half Moon Bay shootings, he said.

“I didn’t want to be here, and I don’t want to be here,” Mr. Newsom said, pulling notes out of his pocket that he said contained the same talking points he used after

Continued on Page A18

UKRAINE WILL GET
ADVANCED TANKS,
U.S. OFFICIALS SAY

BID TO SPUR GERMANY

Zelensky Seeking Armor
From West to Reclaim
Land From Russia

By HELENE COOPER
and ERIC SCHMITT

WASHINGTON — Reversing its longstanding resistance, the Biden administration plans to send M1 Abrams tanks to Ukraine, U.S. officials said on Tuesday, in what would be a major step in arming Kyiv in its efforts to seize back its territory from Russia.

The White House is expected to announce a decision as early as Wednesday, said the officials, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitivity of the discussions. Two officials said the number of Abrams tanks could be about 30.

Over the last month, Pentagon officials had expressed misgivings about sending the Abrams, citing concerns about how Ukraine would maintain the advanced tanks, which require extensive training and servicing.



MATEUSZ SŁODKOWSKI/AFP — GETTY IMAGES

The U.S. may send as many as 30 M1 Abrams tanks to Kyiv.

And officials said it could take years for them to actually reach any Ukrainian battlefields.

But Defense Secretary Lloyd J. Austin III has now come around to the view that committing to sending American tanks is necessary to spur Germany to follow with its coveted Leopard 2 tanks. Officials at the State Department and the White House argued that giving Germany the political cover it sought to send its own tanks outweighed the Defense Department reluctance, the officials said.

The movement toward sending the Abrams tanks, first reported by The Wall Street Journal, follows a testy confrontation last week during a NATO defense chiefs meeting over the refusal by Germany’s chancellor, Olaf Scholz, to send the Leopards, which many military experts believe could be a critical weapon in Ukrainian hands.

German officials privately insisted that they would send the tanks, among the most advanced in the world, only if the United

Continued on Page A10

SHAKE-UP Ukraine fired several top officials after allegations of government corruption. PAGE A8

Nations Face Crushing Cost of Medical Miracles

By REBECCA ROBBINS
and STEPHANIE NOLEN

RECIFE, Brazil — Suhellen Oliveira Da Silva was six months pregnant when she learned that the child she was carrying had the same disease that had left her firstborn son paralyzed and nearly mute. But this time, there was a treatment available that could make a profound difference. This baby could live a normal life.

The problem was the price: The

Therapies Treating Few
Strain System for All

treatment cost the equivalent of \$1.7 million, and the public health system in Brazil, where the family lives, was refusing to pay for it.

So Ms. Da Silva went to court — and won. A judge ruled that the government had to buy the therapy for her younger son, Levi.

Today, Levi, 2, chats and claps and crawls, all things his older brother Lorenzo, 10, has never been able to do.

The treatment, called Zolgensma, a one-time infusion, is among the first in a new class of cutting-edge gene therapies that offer enormous promise for people with fatal or debilitating conditions — at hugely expensive prices. Its maker, the pharmaceutical company Novartis, has negotiated deals with national health

Continued on Page A6

Across Tech, Easy Money Yields to Hard Times

By DAVID STREITFELD

Eighteen months ago, the online used car retailer Carvana had such great prospects that it was worth \$80 billion. Now it is valued at less than \$1.5 billion, a 98 percent plunge, and is struggling to survive.

Many other tech companies are also seeing their fortunes reverse and their dreams dim. They are shedding employees, cutting back, watching their financial val-

Ultralow Rates Fueled
Giants and Start-Ups

uations shrivel — even as the larger economy chugs along with a low unemployment rate and a 3.2 percent annualized growth rate in the third quarter.

One largely unacknowledged explanation: An unprecedented era of rock-bottom interest rates

has abruptly ended. Money is no longer virtually free.

For over a decade, investors desperate for returns sent their money to Silicon Valley, which pumped it into a wide range of start-ups that might not have received a nod in less heady times. Extreme valuations made it easy to issue stock or take on loans to expand aggressively or to offer sweet deals to potential customers that quickly boosted market share.

Continued on Page A16



NATIONAL A11-19

Deadly Dose in Delivery Room
Inspectors found that an anesthesiologist at a Brooklyn hospital made several life-threatening errors. PAGE A14

Two Democrats Off Committee
Speaker Kevin McCarthy barred Adam B. Schiff and Eric Swalwell from the House Intelligence Committee. PAGE A19

INTERNATIONAL A4-10

Ottawa’s Nuclear Bunker
Amid renewed tensions with Russia, tourists are flocking to Canada’s decommissioned fallout shelter. PAGE A4

BUSINESS B1-5

Long Covid Takes Toll
A significant number of people are still out of the work force because of the condition, a study found. PAGE B1

U.S. Sues Google, Again
The Justice Department’s antitrust lawsuit, which a group of states joined, was the fifth by U.S. officials against the company since 2020. PAGE B1



ARTS C1-6

A Flurry of Oscar Nominations
“Everything Everywhere All at Once,” with Michelle Yeoh, above, is the film receiving the most attention. PAGE C1

Gliding to the Music
At City Ballet, Justin Peck’s program brings Aaron Copland’s classic ballet scores under one roof, at last. PAGE C1

FOOD D1-8

Winning Winter Salads
January is a tough time for vegetables, so we’re passing along four recipes that prove just how good they can be, especially when they are roasted until their natural sweetness shines. PAGE D1

Fine Dining’s Coarse Side
Reports of cases of unpaid labor at some of the world’s most expensive restaurants raise a question: What’s the human cost of this type of extravagant eating, and will it last? PAGE D1

OPINION A20-21

Bret Stephens PAGE A21



SPORTS B6-9

Shiffrin Surpasses Her Idol
Mikaela Shiffrin passed Lindsey Vonn — another American star — by winning her 83rd World Cup race, the most by a female skier. PAGE B6



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